

SHOKI'S ADVENTURE

DDG Module — Week 6 Early Presentation

Grid-based tactical combat · 10 waves · Survive or be captured

Engine

Unity 6

Genre

Tactics / Roguelite

Deadline

Week 6

GAME CONCEPT

Shoki is an alien crash-landed on Earth. Survive 10 waves of government soldiers on an 8×8 isometric grid — repair your ship and escape home.

Into the Breach

Enemy telegraph system — enemies reveal their attack targets before acting. Player can react and dodge.

Mewgenics

Entity-driven emergent behaviour. Characters act independently based on their own internal logic.

Shovel Knight

2D pixel art aesthetic. Clear readable sprites on a clean grid. Chunky, expressive characters.

TWO INTERACTIVE ELEMENTS

ELEMENT 1 — Enemy AI

SEE

Detects Shoki's grid position at the start of each round

PROCESS

Computes move path + attack target, broadcasts intent via yellow telegraph tiles on the board

ACT

Executes its telegraphed plan — moves first, then attacks the committed tile (even if Shoki has moved away)

3 types: Soldier (rushes melee), Sniper (keeps distance, ranged), Heavy (slow, high HP)

ELEMENT 2 — Environmental Traps

COLLISION

Any entity stepping onto a trap tile activates it — player OR enemy

PROCESS

Trap type determines effect: Spike (10 dmg), Pit (instant kill), Slow Zone (−1 move range next turn)

ACT

Effect applied immediately on entry — damage dealt, movement reduced, or entity removed

Key: enemies can be *BAITED* into traps — the two elements interact directly.

CHALLENGE

Every turn is a puzzle. No two turns are the same.

- Read enemy telegraph tiles before moving
- Positioning determines what you can attack
- Bait enemies into traps with smart movement

Read the board

Yellow tiles show where enemies will attack next turn.

Positioning

Stand on the wrong tile after moving and take avoidable damage.

Melee vs. ranged

Choose attack mode each turn based on range and upgrade build.

Trap baiting

Route enemies through Spike or Pit tiles — use their telegraphed movement.

Build your run

Stacking multipliers over 10 waves forces long-term commitment choices.

CORE LOOPS

MICRO

One turn

- Move up to 2 tiles on the grid
- Trap triggers if you enter a trap tile
- Attack — melee (8 tiles) or ranged (2–4 tiles)
- End turn → enemies execute their telegraphed plans

Repeats for each entity per initiative order

MACRO

One wave

- Survive all enemies in the wave
- Heal 50% of damage taken this wave
- Choose upgrade: +25% Melee OR Ranged dmg
- Waves 3 / 6 / 9: choose a Companion

Loops 10 times per run

META

Full run

- HP carries over — no reset between waves
- Stack damage multipliers across all 10 waves
- Build a Companion team (max 3, permadeath)
- Survive wave 10 to escape — WIN

One run, no save states

INTERESTING CHOICES

Every turn

Melee vs. Ranged

- Melee: hits ALL 8 adjacent tiles — high damage, risky positioning required
- Ranged: single target, 2–4 tiles away — safe but weaker
- Each upgraded independently — commits you to a build early

Post-wave

Upgrade Pick

- +25% Melee damage multiplier
- +25% Ranged damage multiplier
- Multipliers compound — $\times 1.75$ by wave 7 if you focus one path

Waves 3, 6, 9

Companion Pick

- DRONE — glass cannon ranged (HP 20, 2–4 tile range)
- BRAWLER — tanky melee (HP 40, soaks damage)
- TRICKSTER — acts TWICE per turn (HP 25, flexible)
- Permadeath — companion is gone permanently if killed

RANDOMNESS & BALANCING

Randomness Sources

Initiative order

d20 + speed stat rolled each round — player and enemies act in result order

Room layout

Full 8×8 grid regenerates after every wave with new obstacle and trap positions

Trap placement

Fixed counts (1 spike, 1 slow zone, 2 obstacles) at valid random positions

Enemy spawns

Edge-based spawn pool with minimum 3-tile separation from Shoki's start

Balancing Decisions

Enemy scaling

+1 enemy every 2–3 waves — keeps early waves learnable

HP persistence

Player HP carries over — every wave has real consequences

Companion cap

Max 3 companions + permadeath prevents late-game snowballing

Multiplier start

Upgrades start at ×1.0 — power is earned, not given

Board reads state at a glance



Blue tile

Valid move destination



Orange tile

Valid attack target



Yellow tile (pulsing)

Enemy will attack here next turn



Grey outline tile

Enemy will move here next turn



Amber tile

Spike trap (10 dmg on entry)



Dark tile

Pit trap — instant kill

PLAYABILITY

Highlights show all valid actions before clicking. No hidden information. Controls reminder on-screen at all times.

ACCESSIBILITY

Three inputs only: mouse click, Q (toggle mode), Space (end turn). Turn-based — zero time pressure. High-contrast UI.

JUICINESS

Telegraph tiles pulse with alpha animation. HP bar updates live. Heal feedback on post-wave screen. Highlights clear instantly on state change.

DESIGN ITERATIONS (2 completed)

V1

CHANGED

Top-down grid

WHAT

Started as a flat top-down orthographic grid.

WHY

Depth and positioning were unclear — hard to read spatial relationships at a glance.

OUTCOME

Pivoted to isometric. Rebuilt tile math, highlight system, and entity sort ordering.

V2

DROPPED

Pokémon type system

WHAT

Early design had type advantages — attacks countered specific enemy types.

WHY

Added complexity without improving the Challenge fun. Obscured positioning decisions.

OUTCOME

Removed. Kept 3 distinct enemy types with clear visual roles instead.

V3

ACTIVE

Current prototype

WHAT

Isometric 8×8 grid, telegraph system, companions, damage multiplier upgrades.

WHY

All major loops playable. Tile highlights, AI turns, traps all functional.

OUTCOME

Presenting this build. Planned additions: sound, sprite polish, difficulty tuning.

NARRATIVE + ASSET LIST

Narrative

Protagonist

Shoki — alien, sympathetic underdog stranded on Earth after crash

Antagonist

Government forces closing in — soldiers, snipers, heavy units

Goal

Survive 10 waves → repair ship → escape. Each wave = new ambush

Environment

Crash site — traps are industrial debris and electrical hazards

Companions

Survivors Shoki rescues; they fight alongside him and can die permanently

Asset List

Player	Shoki sprite (Aseprite PNG)
Enemies	Soldier, Sniper, Heavy sprites
Companions	Drone, Brawler, Trickster sprites
Tiles	Ground iso1, Ground iso2 (32×32 iso)
Overlays	Move HL, Attack HL, Telegraph ×2
Traps	Spike, Pit, Slow Zone tile sprites
Audio	SFX: attack, move, hurt (planned)
UI	HP bar, wave HUD, upgrade screen, end screens

REQUIREMENTS CHECKLIST

- Two interactive elements (Enemy AI + Traps interact with each other)
- LeBlanc fun type — Challenge
- GDD using HSLU template
- Core loop diagram (micro / macro / meta)
- Interesting choices — melee vs ranged, upgrades, companions
- Playability + Accessibility + Juiciness addressed
- Done
- In progress
- Randomness — initiative, room layout, spawns, trap placement
- Visual gamestate — tile colour coding + telegraph system
- Narrative — Shoki's crash-landing escape story
- 2 iterations documented (top-down → iso, type system dropped)
- Design patterns to be listed in final GDD
- Balancing document to be expanded post-playtesting